



Concept Note

Regional Workshop on the Updating and Advancing the Initial Pipeline of ASEAN Infrastructure Projects

9–10 April 2025, Marriott Putrajaya Hotel, Putrajaya, Malaysia

(Draft as of 20 February 2025)

1. Background

ASEAN, through the Lead Implementing Body for Sustainable Infrastructure (LIB-SI), is updating the Initial Rolling Priority Pipeline of ASEAN Infrastructure Projects (the “Initial Pipeline”) to accelerate investment into infrastructure, supporting the movement of people, services, goods and innovation, with due consideration to emerging trends and priorities on connectivity.

With support from the Australia for ASEAN Futures (Aus4ASEAN Futures) Initiative, the Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corporation (SMBC) Singapore Branch has been engaged as consultant—through a competitive tender process—to assist in this Pipeline updating process through the Project on the **“Advancing and Updating the Initial Rolling Priority Pipeline of ASEAN Infrastructure through Innovative Financial Approaches”** (the “Project”). In accordance with the schedule of the Project, SMBC has conducted various in-country consultations to present the Project to potential project owners in ASEAN member States (“AMS”) and assist project owners in their submissions of additional infrastructure projects.

In this process, SMBC has noted that a number of AMS have indicated difficulty with providing submissions due to the workload required to complete the comprehensive project application form and confidentiality considerations. SMBC and the ASEAN Secretariat have further worked together to address the concerns raised by AMS, including by coming up with the abridged version of the Project Application Form.

SMBC has received a number of project submissions from AMS. The projects submitted have been screened based on the agreed criteria to select the shortlisted projects to be added into the Initial Pipeline, to form the Updated Pipeline of ASEAN Infrastructure Projects (the “Updated Pipeline”). The progress of this process is being detailed in the draft Interim Report of the Project to be shared with AMS prior to the Workshop.

2. Formats and Objectives of the Workshop

The Workshop will be held in plenary and breakout discussion formats. It aims to discuss issues related to updating the Initial Pipeline, which will include SMBC’s interim findings in the draft Interim Report and garner further inputs and feedback. The Workshop is also expected to serve as a platform for a productive dialogue and conversation among the AMS project owners and stakeholders from various relevant sectors. Noting the potential project confidentiality consideration at the current stage,

the Workshop will not include the participation by the ASEAN's Dialogue Partners and other external partners.

Relevant AMS project owners will have the opportunity to present their projects. Depending on the needs of each project shortlisted for the Updated Pipeline, SMBC and participants will provide inputs on bankability, financial analysis, and market sounding for the project, which may include liaising with appropriate external partners if so required. This Workshop is also intended to include capacity building elements. For knowledge and best practices sharing, SMBC will also provide informational sessions, such as on the state of the financing market, including the relevant key developments, trends, and opportunities in financing connectivity projects in the region.

The Workshop will involve AMS representatives participating in breakout discussions to brainstorm priorities and current gaps in advancing ASEAN Connectivity, enabling sharing of feedback for the overall Project and draft Interim Report. The outcomes emanating from the Workshop will feed into the draft Final Report of the Project.

3. Expected Workshop Outcomes

The Outcomes of the Workshop are anticipated to include:

- Overall feedback and project-specific recommendations to enhance ASEAN Connectivity, project feasibility, bankability, and strategic alignment;
- Refined project submissions incorporating the feedback and recommendations from the participants;
- Actional next steps and follow-up plans for the Updated Pipeline;
- Improved understanding among participants of their roles in advancing sustainable infrastructure in ASEAN; and
- Strengthened knowledge on ASEAN Connectivity as well as sustainable infrastructure prioritisation and financing opportunities.

4. Target Participants

The Workshop is expected to attract around 80-90 participants, comprising representatives from the following:

- a. Lead Implementing Body for Sustainable Infrastructure (LIB-SI);
- b. Senior Transport Officials Meeting (STOM);
- c. Senior Officials Meeting on Energy (SOME);
- d. ASEAN Digital Senior Officials Meeting (ADGSOM);
- e. Working Committee on Capital Market Development – Infrastructure Financing Working Group (WCCMD-IFWG);
- f. ASEAN Smart Cities Network (ASCN);
- g. Project Owners; and
- h. ASEAN Secretariat

5. Agenda

The Workshop is anticipated to be delivered across one and a half (1.5) days. An initial draft of the Workshop Agenda is outlined below.

Day 1: 9 April 2025 (Wednesday)

Time: 0900 – 1640

Time (GMT+8)	Agenda	Format
0830 – 0900	Registration for Day 1	
0900 – 0905	Opening remarks LIB-SI Chair	Plenary
0905 – 0910	Opening remarks by representative of the Government of Australia	Plenary
0910 – 0915	Photo Session	Plenary
0915 – 1000	SMBC presentation and Q&A on the Project overview, status, challenges, and interim findings	Plenary
1000 – 1030	Informational session: SMBC presentation and Q&A on the state of the financing market (ECAs, DFIs, commercial lenders) and general bankability considerations (such as with examples of relevant connectivity projects financed in recent years)	Plenary
1030 – 1045	Coffee break	
1045 – 1155	Presentations by project owners on potential projects (3-4 projects) <i>(Note: 15min presentation + 5min Q&A for each Project)</i>	Plenary
1155 – 1330	Lunch break	
1330 – 1400	Informational session: SMBC presentation and Q&A on key developments, challenges, and opportunities in transportation infrastructure in the region	Plenary
1400 – 1515	Brainstorming and deep dive on the projects presented, including feedback and suggestions on improving the projects <i>(Note: Participants will be grouped based on country, to reflect on each of the potential projects presented, including on the strategic relevance, connectivity, resilience, socio-economic benefits, environment, and feasibility considerations. Participants may also wish to share relevant experience on past or ongoing similar projects in their country, if any)</i>	Breakout
1515 – 1545	Reporting back from the Breakout session	Plenary
1545 – 1600	Coffee break	
1600 – 1630	Informational session: SMBC presentation and Q&A on key developments, challenges, and opportunities in digital infrastructure in the region	Plenary

Time (GMT+8)	Agenda	Format
1630 – 1640	Wrapping up of Day 1	Plenary

Day 2: 10 April 2025 (Thursday)

Time: 0900 – 1230

Time (GMT+8)	Agenda	Format
0830 – 0900	Registration for Day 2	
0900 – 0910	Opening by SMBC to summarise Day 1 discussions	Plenary
0910 – 1020	Presentations by project owners on potential projects (3-4 projects) <i>(Note: 15min presentation + 5min Q&A for each Project)</i>	Plenary
1020 – 1035	Coffee break	
1035 – 1135	Brainstorming and deep dive on the projects presented, including feedback and suggestions on improving the projects <i>(Note: Participants will be grouped based on country, to reflect on each of the potential projects presented, including on the strategic relevance, connectivity, resilience, socio-economic benefits, environment, and feasibility considerations. Participants may also wish to share relevant experience on past or ongoing similar projects in their country, if any)</i>	Breakout
1135 – 1205	Reporting back from the Breakout session	Plenary
1205 – 1215	Wrapping up of Day 2 and next steps	Plenary
1215 – 1225	Event Online Survey	Plenary
1225 – 1230	Closing remarks by ASEAN Secretariat	Plenary
1230 – 1400	Lunch	
1400 – 1530	Further follow up / bilateral meetings between interested ASEAN Member States and project consultant SMBC to further discuss and provide further support on project submissions (optional)	
